

netbook equipped with a six-cell battery has a much longer life facilitating daylong computing.

What matters the most?

The processors and many other configurations are almost the same for netbooks. The things that really matter are:

1. What do you want the netbook for?
2. How much battery life is needed?
3. Is the keyboard comfortable to work with?
4. What connectivity options are available?

Purpose. The most important thing to do when you decide to buy a netbook is understand your requirements. Be aware that netbooks are meant for everyday computing. A netbook is ideal for simple tasks such as surfing the Web and sending e-mails when you are constantly on the move. However, it is not suitable for heavy computing or gaming functions due to limitations posed by the processor.

Battery life. Depending on the use of

ASUS Eee PC S101H

Platform	: Intel Atom N270 CPU with 1.6GHz, Intel 945G chipset
Operating system	: Windows XP
Memory (RAM)	: 1GB
Display	: 25.9cm (LED)
Storage	: 160GB + 10GB Eee storage
Battery type & Life	: 2-cell, 5 hours (Li-polymer battery)
Communication	: 1.3-megapixel CMOS webcam, 802.11 b/g/n WLAN, Bluetooth BT 2.0
Dimensions and weight	: 1.06 kg
I/O ports	: 3 USB ports



the netbook, choose the battery type. A 3-cell battery will suffice a netbook that is used primarily at home. However, 6-cell batteries are recommended if you require longer battery life while you are in transit.

Keyboard. A comfortable keyboard is essential to a good computing experience, especially if you type fast and for long periods. It is recommended to choose keyboards which are 85 to 90 per cent of the size of a fully-functional keyboard.

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Connectivity options. Since netbooks lack the option of an in-built CD/DVD R/W+, the connectivity options to the memory devices become vital. For instance, a 3-in-1 multimemory slot will enable you to enjoy the multimedia files stored on the memory devices. The presence of Bluetooth 2.0+EDR will offer enhanced connectivity and synchronisation with other devices. Wi-Fi b/g/n is recommended as it is six times faster than Wi-Fi b/g.

Do's and don'ts

Do understand your needs before you make a buying decision. Research and compare the model you decide to buy with other options in the market. Don't buy from companies which are not specialised in netbook category. And don't buy any netbook just because it's lower in price, the inferior quality may come back to hurt you. ●

The author is a deputy editor at Efy. The prices mentioned by her are only indicative and may vary

HP Mini 1109TU

Platform	: Intel Atom processor N270 (1.6GHz, 533MHz front-side bus speed (FSB), 512KB On-die L2 cache), Mobile Intel 945GSE Express Chipset
Operating system	: Windows XP Home – SP3
Memory (RAM)	: 1GB PC2-4200 DDR2 (533MHz), 1 SODIMM slot (occupied)
Display	: 25.7cm LED-backlit widescreen, 1024x576 standard definition (SD)
Storage	: 80GB (PATA) @ 4200 RPM
Battery type & Life	: 3-cell Li-ion
Graphics	: Intel Graphics Media Accelerator 950
Communication	: Integrated 10/100 LAN, integrated Bluetooth HP module, integrated wireless LAN 802.11b/g, integrated web camera
Keyboard	: 92% keyboard layout
Dimensions and weight	: 2.5x26.1x16.6 cm ³ , 1.09 kg
I/O ports	: Two USB 2.0 ports, one headphone jack (stereo/microphone In), one RJ-45 jack, one DC power In, expansion port for dock support, mini Lanyard Accessory Slot

